Dutch Start

AI ASSISTANT FOR INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS IN THE NETHERLANDS
PYTHON + STREAMLIT + GEMINI API



DOMILE ZUKAITE
CAMERON RUITER

Problem

- INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS CAN STRUGGLE WITH UNFAMILIAR DUTCH SYSTEMS AND LANGUAGE.
- 129,764 INTERNATIONAL DEGREE STUDENTS WERE ENROLLED IN DUTCH HIGHER EDUCATION IN 2025–26.
- DUTCHSTART FOCUSES ON GOVERNMENT, HOUSING, UNIVERSITY, AND WORK & MONEY.



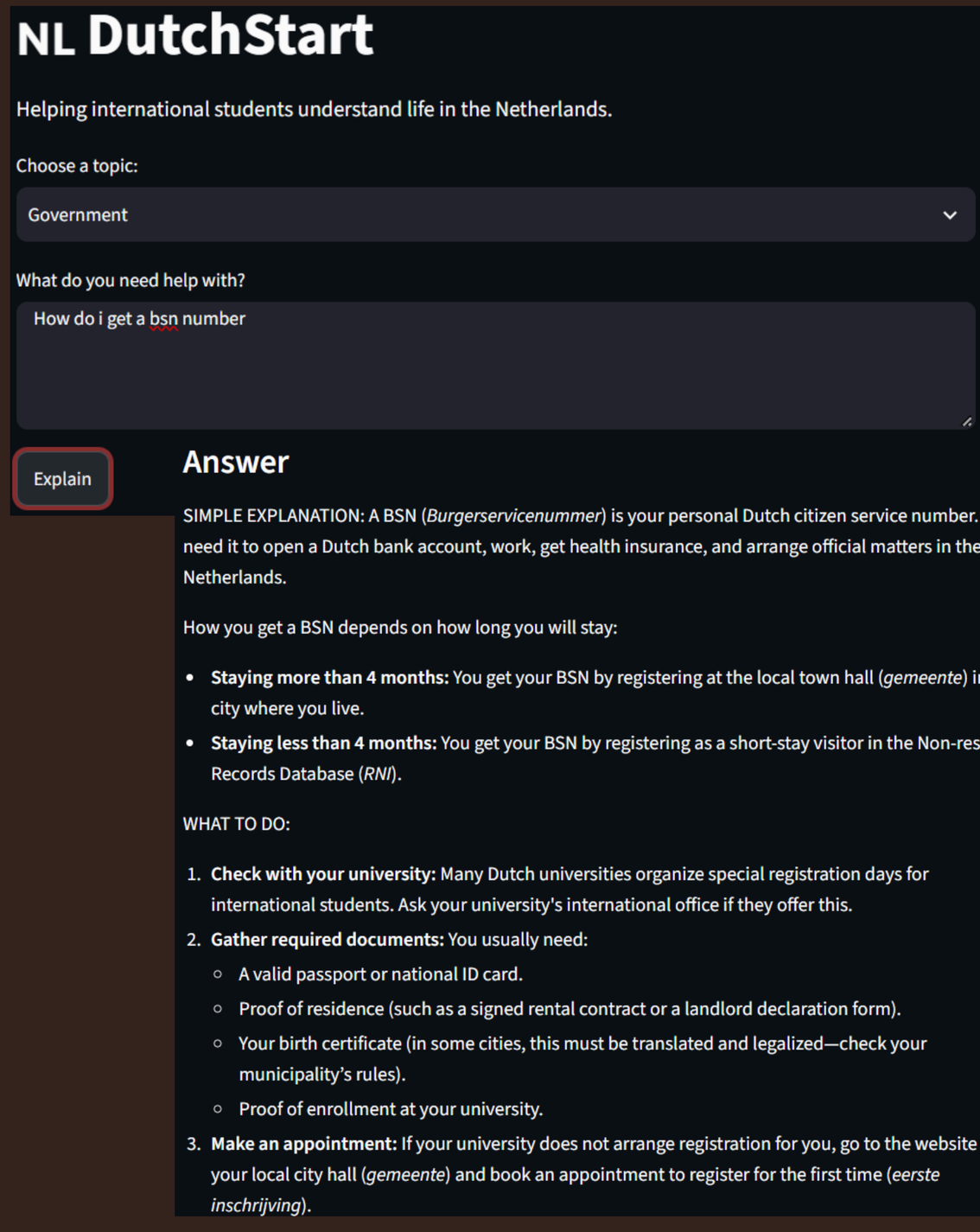
Intended users and boundaries

Intended users: International students in the Netherlands who need help understanding Dutch systems.

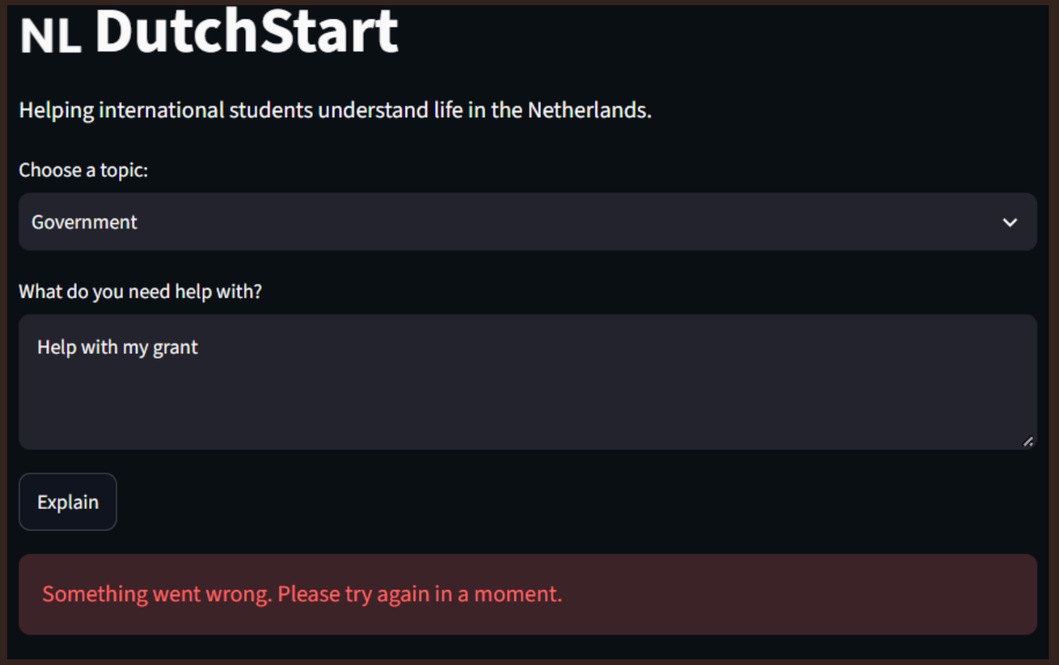
Boundaries: DutchStart gives simple explanations, not professional advice. Important information should be checked with official sources.

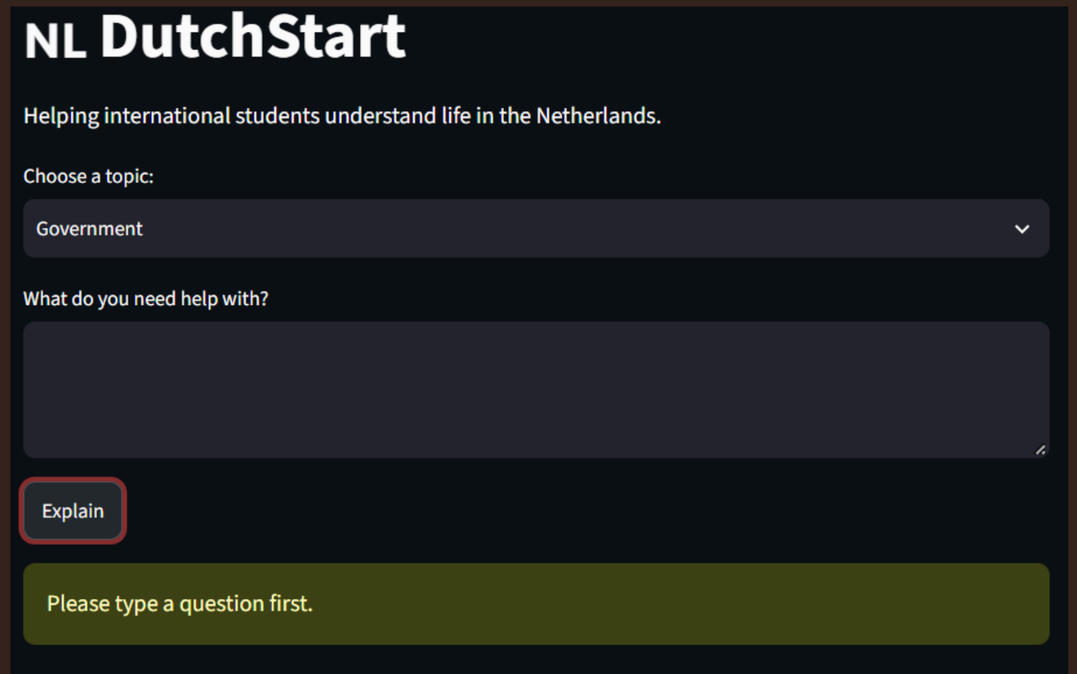
Solution

- CHOOSE A TOPIC AND TYPE A QUESTION.
- GEMINI EXPLAINS IT SIMPLY, GIVES NEXT STEPS, AND EXPLAINS DIFFICULT TERMS.
- IMPORTANT DECISIONS ARE FLAGGED FOR VERIFICATION WITH OFFICIAL SOURCES.



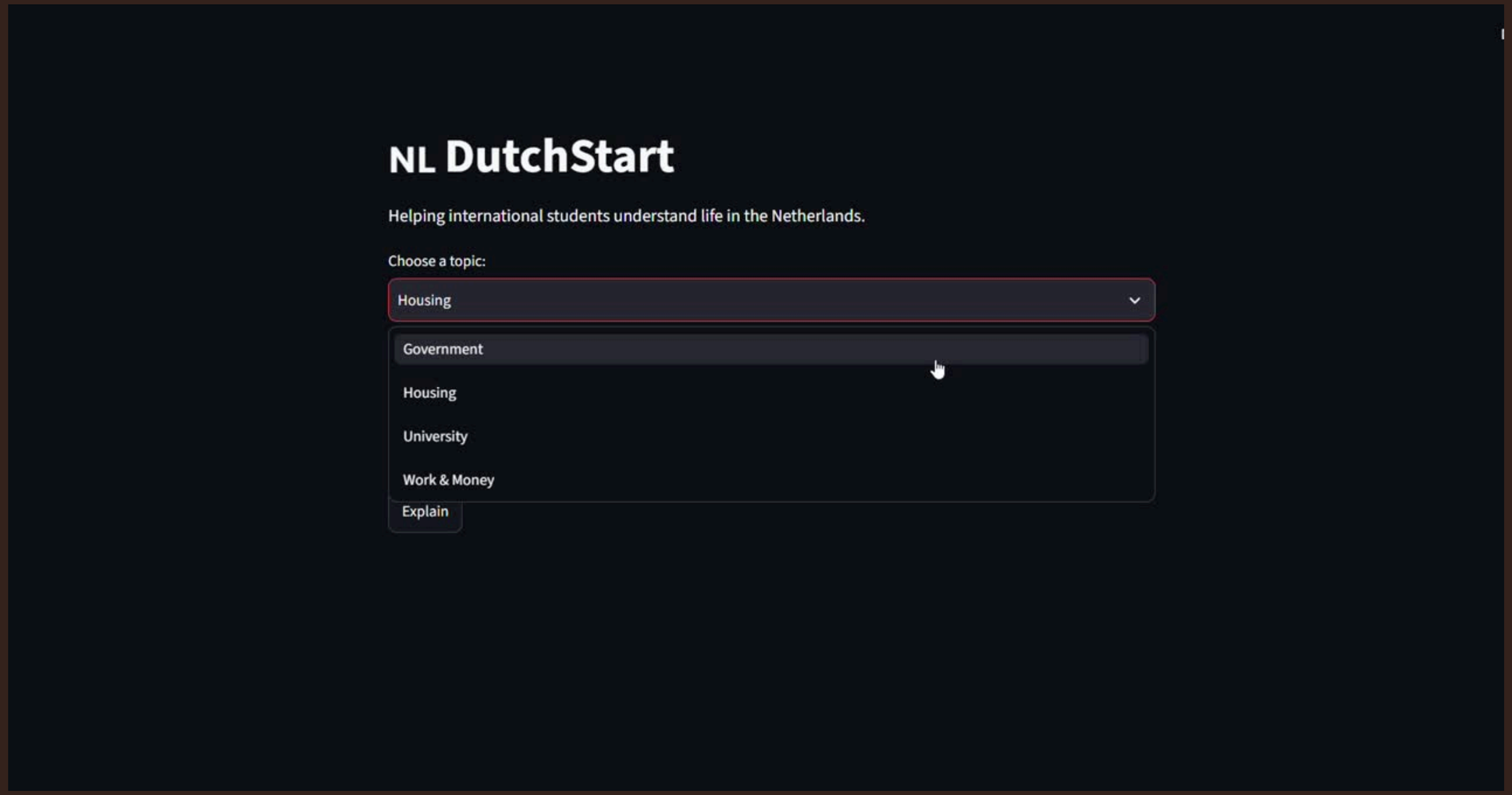
Working prototype





- REAL GEMINI API CALLS THROUGH PYTHON.
- EMPTY QUESTIONS ARE BLOCKED.
- API ERRORS SHOW A FRIENDLY MESSAGE INSTEAD OF CRASHING.

DEMO


NL DutchStart
Helping international students understand life in the Netherlands.
Choose a topic:
Housing
Government
Housing
University
Work & Money
Explain

Ethics & risks



- RISK: AI CAN GIVE INCORRECT OR OUTDATED INFORMATION.

- THIS COULD MISLEAD STUDENTS ABOUT HOUSING, REGISTRATION, WORK, OR UNIVERSITY RULES.

- SAFEGUARDS: NO-INVENTION PROMPT, UNCERTAINTY WARNING, AND OFFICIAL-SOURCE VERIFICATION.

Why it fits SDG 10

Reduced Inequalities

- DUTCHSTART REDUCES INFORMATION BARRIERS FOR INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS.

- AI IS ESSENTIAL BECAUSE EACH STUDENT CAN ASK A DIFFERENT QUESTION.

- GOAL: MAKE IMPORTANT INFORMATION EASIER TO UNDERSTAND AND ACCESS

Thank you